Sanika Satoskar

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Profile

Data scientist with two years of forecasting and experimentation for 20+ global brands at NielsenIQ, now an MS in Applied Data Science student at the University of Chicago. Builds machine learning models, data pipelines, and AI tools in Python, SQL, and PySpark, and turns results into clear business recommendations.

Education

- **University of Chicago** — Chicago, IL
  MS in Applied Data Science; GPA: 4.0/4.0 — *Expected Graduation: Dec 2027*
  Relevant Coursework: Machine Learning, Statistical Models, Time Series Analysis, Generative AI, Data Engineering
- **Sydenham College of Commerce and Economics** — Mumbai, India
  Bachelor of Management Studies (Hons); GPA: 9.52/10.0 ***(Rank 1 – Summa Cum Laude)*** — *April 2024*
  Major: Finance & Data Analytics, Minor: Operations Research

Skills & Certifications

- **Data Science & ML:** Time Series Forecasting, Regression, Logistic Regression, XGBoost, A/B Testing & Experiment Design, Statistical Modeling
- **AI:** Generative AI, LLM Tool-Calling, Prompt Engineering, AI Workflow Automation
- **Data & Tools:** Python (pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn, Matplotlib), SQL (PostgreSQL, MySQL), PySpark, R, Tableau, Streamlit, Git, AWS, Excel
- **Certifications:** McKinsey Forward Program, Financial Modelling Foundations, Inside LVMH Certificate

Professional Experience

- **NielsenIQ – Product Consulting & Data Analyst** — *Jun 2024 – Aug 2026*
  - Built demand forecasts and pricing scenarios for new-product launches across 20+ global CPG brands (Reckitt, Nestlé, PepsiCo, General Mills, Henkel), integrating millions of retail and panel data points into a forecasting model
  - Validated forecasts against actuals one year post-launch across the US and Latin America, landing within ±9%, and fed variance drivers back into model assumptions
  - Designed and analyzed controlled in-market tests (test-vs-control; pack, price, flavor variants), benchmarking velocity and share KPIs to recommend which variant to scale
  - Quantified SKU cannibalization and variety-split effects and turned them into recommendations for client leadership
- **University of Chicago, Student Disability Services – Data & AI Solutions Intern** — *Oct 2026 – Present*
  - Piloting AI-assisted email triage after mapping inbox volume, categories, and response types, with AI ethics and privacy review
  - Analyzing 2 case-management workflows and building Director-level KPI reporting templates from core system data
- **On The Move – Founder's Office** — *Jan 2025 – Aug 2026*
  - Prepared pitch materials and ran outreach and first lead conversations, bringing in 50+ new clients in a year as the startup grew revenue ∼2.3x and its client base 4x+
  - Launched the end-to-end client onboarding process and tracked client acquisition and retention metrics

Projects

- **Fraud Detection on Card Transactions (Python, XGBoost)** — *2026*
  - On ∼285K real transactions (0.17% fraud), XGBoost caught 85% of fraud at a 0.1% false-positive rate vs 82% for a logistic baseline (PR-AUC 0.83 vs 0.71)
- **Retail Category Analytics Pipeline (PySpark, Streamlit)** — *2026*
  - Built a bronze/silver/gold PySpark pipeline turning 1.07M raw transactions into SKU velocity, Pareto, and launch-curve tables, with every rejected row logged by reason, served in a Streamlit dashboard
  - Backtested weekly demand forecasts on a 12-week holdout: a seasonal-naive baseline (17.5% WAPE) beat Holt-Winters (36.9%)
- **Retention Impact: Progression Gate A/B Test**
  - Ran an A/B test across ∼90K players; found the later gate cut 7-day retention by 4.3% ($p = 0.002$) and recommended keeping the earlier gate
- **PayPal AI Hackathon – Merchant Cash-Flow Copilot** — *Oct 2026 – Present*
  - Building an AI agent on PayPal APIs with a Python forecasting module that flags merchants' low-cash weeks

Leadership & Volunteering

- **Rotaract Club of Mumbai Anchors – President:** Led club strategy and operations; Presidential Citation
- **The BMS Society – Chairperson:** Led seminars for 500+ participants; mentored a 120-member team
- **Sydenham Placement Cell – Co-Chairperson:** Coordinated campus placement drives and Career Summit '23
- **Toastmasters Club – Vice President, Public Relations**